

PLABABLE

GEMS

VERSION 1.0

GERIATRIC



Lasting Power of Attorney

A legal document that appoints an individual to **make decision on patient's behalf** regarding **health and financial affairs**

2 Types

Health and welfare

Property and financial affairs

DS1500

A document that has medical facts of a **patient with terminal diseases** who **expected to die within 6 months** - allow patient to claim benefit from government if required

Compos mentis

Having control of one's mind = able to make decision

Advance Directive

Advance directive

A living will = **a legal document** where a patient writes the treatment(s) he/she does not want to receive if they become unable to make decision

e.g. Jehovah's witness usually have advance directive they do not receive blood products

Example

A patient with end-stage renal disease and does not want hospital admission but die peacefully at home if she become ill.

What document is required?

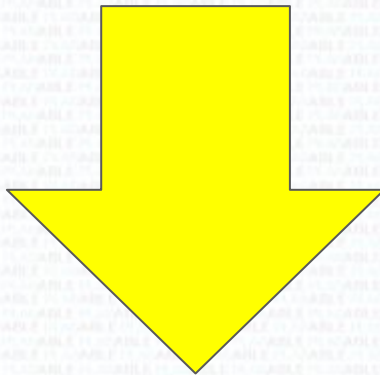
Advance directive is written:

- When patient is **competent**
- When patient is **fully conscious**
- When patient is **able to make decision**
- To be **used when unable to make decision** for any reason

All healthcare professional are **legally to obliged** with this document

Full Fitness Discharge Assessment

It is a **full fitness assessment** by **multiple team** for patient who has been admitted to hospital, to assess appropriateness for discharge taking into **multiple factors: medical and social**



Medically fit for discharge:

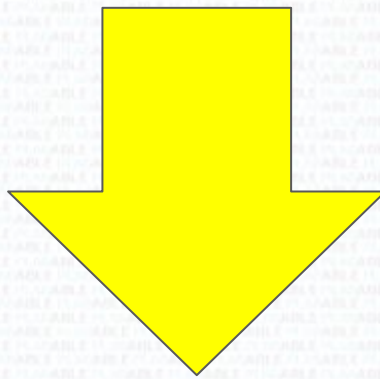
= a condition that led patient to hospital admission has been treated and no further management is required

=DOES NOT take into patient's other comorbidities, weakness, old age or immobility

Full Fitness Discharge Assessment

Full package assessment:

- To check on patient's **wishes and decisions**
- To check on patient's **safety**
- To check on patient's **welfare**
- **Multidisciplinary team** involved e.g. social service, physiotherapist, occupational therapist



Referring to care home / hospice:

- To check on **mental capacity**
- To **gain consent** or next of kin/representatives if no capacity
- To refer to **hospice only with terminal illness**

Delirium In The Elderly

Example:

89 yo male with Hx of prostate cancer, recently developed **confusion**, **polyuria** and **incontinence**. Why?

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graph TD; A[Example: 89 yo male with Hx of prostate cancer, recently developed confusion, polyuria and incontinence. Why?] --> B[Suspect UTI]; A --> C[Suspect bone metastasis]; B --> D[Investigation]; C --> D; D --> E[Urine microscopy, culture and sensitivity]; D --> F[Serum calcium]; E --> G[UTI is most common cause of delirium in elderly]; F --> H[Bone metastasis lead to hypercalcaemia]; H --> I[Hypercalcaemia manifestation: Thirst, confusion, depression, low mood, kidney stones, abdominal pain, constipation, bone pain];
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Suspect UTI

Suspect bone metastasis

Investigation

Urine
microscopy,
culture and
sensitivity

Serum calcium

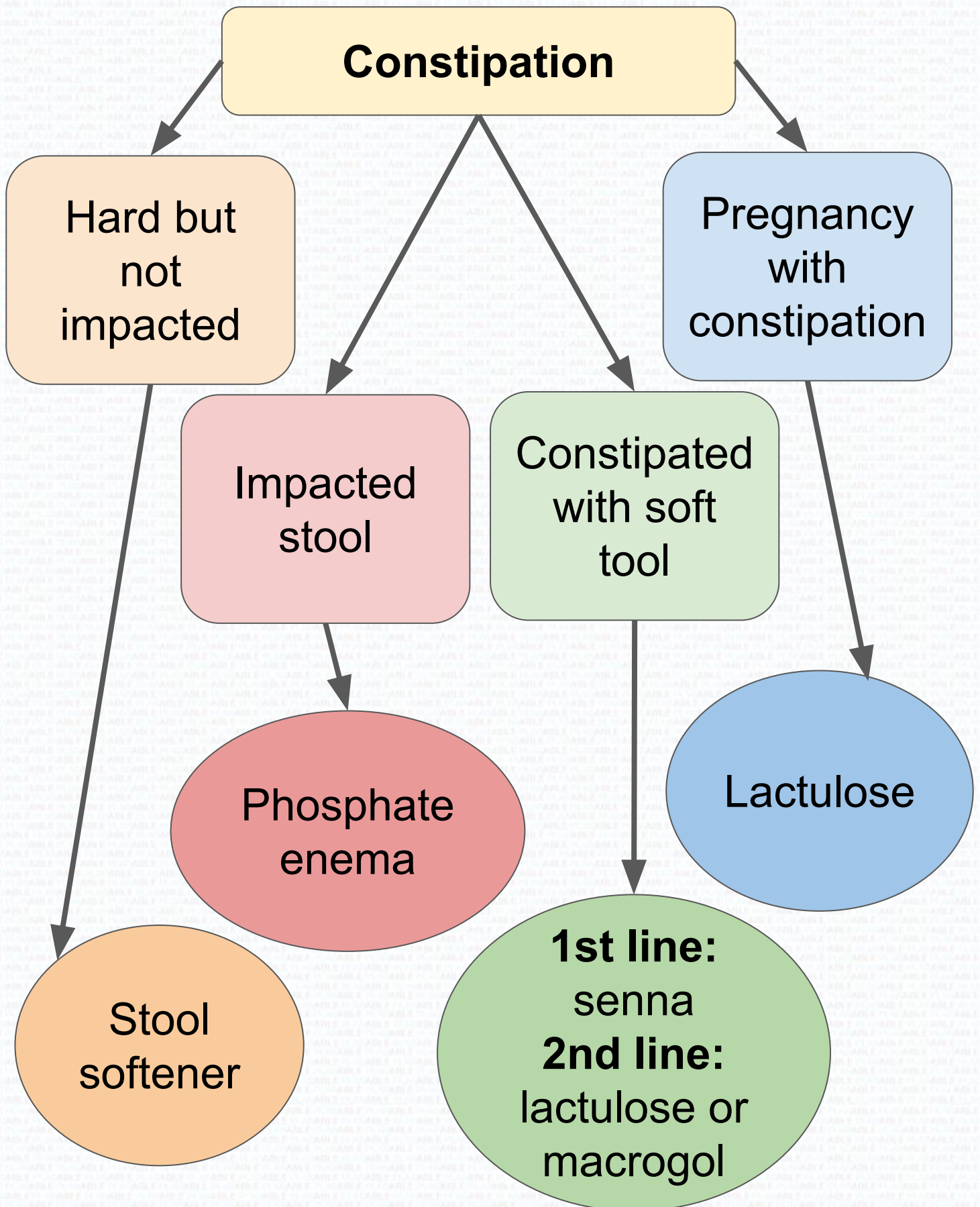
**UTI is most
common cause
of delirium in
elderly**

Bone metastasis
lead to
hypercalcaemia

Hypercalcaemia manifestation:

Thirst, confusion, depression, low mood, kidney stones, abdominal pain, constipation, bone pain

Constipation In The Elderly



Remember!

Keep **hydration** and **high-fibre diet** to reduce constipation

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